

Transcendentalism - Part 1
ESSENTIAL CONCEPTS
2023

The material world - when conceived at planetary scale - is subject to the Newtonian physical laws which are inviolable. Any attempt to violate these laws through mental, ceremonial, or spiritual means will either fail or result in hallucination, possibly even mass hallucination.

What implications does that have for *magick*?

Let's begin by casting aside fantastical ideas of flying broomsticks and bending spoons and look deep into the reality of what is meant by the term magick... which I assure you is far, far more fantastic.

The essential premise of transcendentalism is that we exist as a consciousness on a continuum of manifestation. Here, in the physical world, our consciousness is focused at one extreme end of that continuum. Our physical body is merely the *vehicle* that we control in order to interact with the physical world on its own terms. Therefore, our body is physical. We could theoretically choose a non-physical body to explore this world with. It would have the advantage of not being impeded by walls or other structures. But it would have the

extreme disadvantage of being incapable of altering anything physical or even being able to be seen by physical vehicles. Only people with heightened awareness of their own transcendental nature would be able to perceive your existence and that would be highly variable from person to person.

So, by default, we make our astral vehicles of the same stuff as the world we wish to inhabit. That means that in order to visit another world - which is really just a band of consciousness along the continuum - we must have a vehicle prepared.

In the physical world, this means someone else has to give birth to it. Then they must care for it until it is developed enough to become self-sufficient. But there is no rental or ride-share program available here... at least not usually. Once you request a physical vehicle, you must claim it by entering the moment it's ready, which is some point after conception and before delivery.

Once you're in the vehicle, any memory of who you are or why you requested the vehicle is erased. Ain't that a bitch? But it's an unavoidable side-effect of transferring your consciousness into the newly-formed physical brain which simply isn't capable of receiving and storing all of that information at that point in its development.

So, you start out in this shiny new vehicle utterly helpless and crapping on yourself. *Smooth*. But you knew what you were getting into and decided to do this anyway. Considering that over 7 billion others have made the same choice must mean it isn't all that bad. Personally, I'll reserve any judgment on that one.

The primary downside to having to follow this arduous procedure for creating a physical vehicle is that forgetting who you are leads most to assume that they are their physical vehicle! By identifying with their

physical vehicle, they are led to making many very poor decisions and causing tremendous amounts of suffering for other travelers. It's the greatest cosmic tragedy of all.

The *great awakening* ⁷¹that we are currently undergoing has nothing to do with technological progress or scientific discovery. It's the awareness, as in knowledge rather than simply belief, that we exist as something much greater than our physical vehicles (note that I refuse to use the term "bodies" for a reason). Scientific Illuminism is thus the means whereby we come to this knowledge.

HOW WE LEARN

Consider that everything you know as the physical world is just one of many. And those other worlds maintain a causal yet abstract link between one another. If that makes your head spin, you're not alone. Transcendentalism is one of the most difficult subjects you will ever learn. The reason why this seems so difficult to wrap your head around has to do with the basic principles of how we learn information.

Even before our birth, our brain starts to process and categorize the various forms of sensory input it receives. We start with some very rudimentary categories like *pleasant* and *unpleasant*. The determination of which category a particular stimulus falls into is based on whether or not the experience of the stimulus results in the brain releasing various pleasure-related chemicals or not.

But as we continue to mature, we begin to figure that there are certain recurring patterns that are likely significant. We hear certain sounds that repeat. And often they repeat in conjunction with receiving visual input, such as being stared at by a hairless monkey making some kind of gesture with its paws. Don't they know that staring is rude?

⁷¹ See: "The Watchers' Message"

Fast-forward a bit and we have a basic mastery of language. We have also developed the ability to extrapolate, reason, and think in the abstract. Now there is a wide open world of learning to be had on literally any subject imaginable. As we begin to learn about a new subject, such as mathematics, our teacher constantly draws analogies between the subject matter and other unrelated things we already know about.

Something like $2 + 4 = 6$ might seem like just meaningless symbols to a person who has never been exposed to mathematics before. So, your teacher describes the numbers in terms of, say, toy bunnies. You know all about toy bunnies, so you are able to reuse that knowledge and experience here by simply reframing the context in which you understand that information. Of course, special cases exist and sometimes the analogy isn't perfect. But to say that something is just like something else but with these few differences is still well within our ability to reason. Repeat that a few thousand times and you now have an impressive body of knowledge that really boils down to just a handful of childhood experiences.

Isn't that convenient? It's almost as if reality is composed of only a handful of essential elements that repeat themselves ad infinitum. How curious...

All throughout our lives we keep learning new things through association with existing things and drawing analogies. It has even been said many times that we are only capable of learning through association. If a truly unique concept were to be conceived, we would be utterly incapable of understanding it. The words would seem like gibberish to us.

Then we bump into the concept of transcendentalism. Analogies do

exist for this concept, but most of them are only known to very highly educated people. The relationship between derivatives and integrals in Calculus, for example, can be used as an analogy for transcendentalism. So too can we draw a comparison with Fourier Transformations. But yet again, this does us little good because most people have no idea what a Fourier Transform is. The most effective analogies leverage common, everyday items or systems. Then one fine day, the perfect analogy just came to me out of nowhere. It resonated with the small handful of people I shared it with. So without further ado, the transcendentalism analogy goes something like...

AN ANALOGY

Imagine a computer with 7 hard drives in it. The first hard drive only contains the basic instructions necessary for booting the *operating system* (OS). This is called the *bootloader*.

The second hard drive contains the instructions for the OS itself. The OS doesn't know how it came to be started. From the OS's perspective, it has always been running because it knows nothing about the bootloader and can find no evidence of one anywhere on its hard drive. The OS launches *programs* that make use of the OS's resources to perform some sort of novel function. The OS doesn't know why it launches programs; it just feels a sudden urge to do so from time to time.

The instructions for the programs are located on disk 3. The programs don't know how they came to be started. From the program's perspective, it always has been started because it knows nothing about the OS and can find no evidence of one anywhere on its hard drive.

Programs need to read data such as configuration files, data caches, and other kinds of metadata. These are located on disk 4. The data has no idea about the existence of programs and only some drunk piece of data by the railroad tracks keeps going on about how they're all being 'accessed' and 'read', but he's crazy and no one listens to him.

Programs also need to write data to save the results of their novel function. This data resides on disk 5. This data simply comes into being from nothing as far as it can discern. It posits that its existence must have had a beginning, but it cannot fathom non-existence, so it prefers to believe that it was always there or that a deity made some already extant data manifest on this drive by an act of divine Will.

The two remaining drives store parity data for fault tolerance because the disks are configured as a RAID 6 array. If you know what that means, good for you. But for the purposes of this analogy, we'll relegate them to a mystery beyond comprehension. Yet, we are aware that these last two disks exist and we know they are essential to our survival of the system, even if we don't understand how.

Maybe that helped, maybe it just made things worse. But it's the best I could come up with. The point being that these 7 disks represent the 7 transcendental Worlds of the Theosophical Model. On each of those disks resides data that thinks it is utterly independent of the others because it can find no proof of their existence. Meanwhile, its very existence is actually contingent upon the existence of and actions taken by the other disks in an unbroken chain of dependency (OK, disks 4 and 5 break the chain of dependency, but that's what I mean by analogies not being perfect!).

PUSHING MY LUCK

For my last trick, I'll need a volunteer from the audience to help me squeeze this analogy for everything it's worth.

The last sentence in the description of disk 2 is going to be wedged in to force this analogy to go the distance. The obvious answer to the mystery is that programs are launched at the behest of a user. The user is the one who built the entire system and operates it. The problem with the system described is that it lacks any will to do anything. Without any other outside interference, the system would either not exist or be utterly dormant forever. The user of this system could be any living organism sufficiently intelligent to understand the interface. I say it that way because what the user is is not what's important. What's important is what the user represents: Consciousness.

It will surely come as no surprise to learn that the fundamental

building block of everything is consciousness. Consciousness is the one thing that transcends every transcendental world. And the first world? It is nothing but pure consciousness, free of any creation at all! Emanating from that first world is increasingly more dense manifestations or creations of consciousness, starting with self-awareness, moving on to Will, then inspiration and creativity, then intelligence, then emotions, and finally... matter.